

NEONATAL INFANT PAIN SCALE (NIPS)

Behavioral Pain Assessment in Premature and Full-Term Neonates

1. PATIENT IDENTIFICATION

Patient Name: _____

Age / DOB: ____/____/____

MRN / ID: _____

Unit / Ward / Bed: _____

Surgery / Diagnosis: _____

Date / Time: ____/____/____ : ____

SIX BEHAVIORAL AND PHYSIOLOGICAL CRITERIA

Clinical Parameter	Options & Scoring Criteria	Score
1. Facial Expression Muscle relaxation vs grimace	☐ Relaxed: Restful face, neutral expression (0) ☐ Grimace: Tight facial muscles, furrowed brow, chin quiver (1)	[]
2. Cry Audible vocal quality	☐ No cry: Quiet, not crying (0) ☐ Whimper: Mild moaning, intermittent cry (1) ☐ Vigorous cry: Loud scream, continuous, high-pitched (2)	[]
3. Breathing Patterns Respiratory effort	☐ Relaxed: Usual baseline respiratory pattern (0) ☐ Change in breathing: Irregular, faster, gagging, breath-holding (1)	[]
4. Arms Movement Upper limb tension	☐ Relaxed / Restrained: No muscular rigidity, spontaneous movement (0) ☐ Flexed / Extended: Tense, straight arms, rigid extension or flexion (1)	[]
5. Legs Movement Lower limb tension	☐ Relaxed / Restrained: No muscular rigidity, relaxed limbs (0) ☐ Flexed / Extended: Tense, kicking, rigid leg extension or flexion (1)	[]
6. State of Arousal Sleep-wake alertness	☐ Sleeping / Awake: Quiet, peaceful, alert and settled (0) ☐ Fussy: Alert, restless, thrashing, crying intermittently (1)	[]

TOTAL SCORE: [] POINTS (Maximum: 7 points (0 to 7))

Assessor (RN / License #): _____

CLINICAL INTERPRETATION & RECOMMENDED NURSING ACTIONS

Comfortable / No Pain (0 - 2 points)

Infant comfortable. Maintain supportive developmental care (nesting, swaddling).

Mild to Moderate Pain (3 - 4 points)

Non-pharmacological comfort (sucrose, non-nutritive sucking, kangaroo care).

Severe Pain (≥ 5 points)

Prompt analgesic intervention required (pharmacological therapy) and reassessment in 15-30m.

Registered Nurse (RN) Signature & Professional Stamp

Date & Time of Assessment